

Crop & Store Risk Assessments

Combinable Crops & Sugar Beet — Red Tractor self-assessment support · Prepared 24 September 2026

DRAFT — this covers three separate audit-day requirements in one document. Sections marked [CONFIRM] need James's input before the inspection; everything else is drawn from farm records already on file.

1. Growing Crop Risk Assessment

Purpose: identify risks to food safety, the environment and crop quality arising from growing crops at Upper Assendon Farm, and the controls in place to manage them.

Risk area	Hazard	Control in place	Status
Contamination from adjoining land/roads	Spray drift, dust, litter blown onto crops	Buffer strips maintained on field margins (SFI/CS arable margins — see Farm Map); hedgerows managed per BE3	In place
Water/soil contamination	No watercourses or ditches on the farm (confirmed 24 Sep 2026)	No water-proximity exclusion zones apply on this holding	Confirmed — low risk
Pest/disease/weed risk to stored or standing crop	[CONFIRM] specific pressures for this season's rotation	Rotation planning, resistant varieties where used, monitoring — detail to be added	[CONFIRM with James/agronomist]
Contamination from previous land use / neighbouring livestock	Cross-contamination at field boundaries shared with grazing land	Fields grazed by cattle are rotated separately from combinable crop ground; no shared water troughs between arable and stock fields	In place
Machinery/fuel spillage on cropped land	Diesel, oil, hydraulic fluid spills	Spill kit held; refuelling away from watercourses (n/a — none on farm) and away from grain stores	In place
High-risk areas identified on the farm map	[CONFIRM] any specific high-risk areas beyond the above	See Farm Map — Working Reference for building/field layout	[CONFIRM]

2. Grain Store Risk Assessment

Purpose: identify risks to stored grain quality and safety (contamination, pest ingress, spoilage, structural/fire risk) and the controls in place.

Risk area	Hazard	Control in place / needed	Status
Vermin ingress	Rodents/birds contaminating stored grain	Vermin control programme in place (see Vermin Control Annual Site Survey) — confirm survey frequency (annual vs quarterly, being checked with James)	In place — frequency to confirm
Moisture/heating (spoilage, mycotoxins)	Damp grain, hot spots, mould/mycotoxin development	Underfloor cooling/drying fan in the corn store; [CONFIRM] monitoring routine —	[CONFIRM routine, then start logging]

		see Grain Storage Strategy & Records Pack	
Chemical contamination	Residues from previous store use, spray drift, rodenticide	Store cleaned between harvests (see Grain Store Cleaning Record); chemicals stored separately in the pesticide store	In place
Structural/fire risk	Building condition, electrics, dust	Building maintained (covered under general Housing & Facilities checklist); [CONFIRM] any recent electrical/fire safety check	[CONFIRM]
Cross-contamination between grain lots/varieties	Mixing varieties or treated/untreated seed	Store cleaned and store records kept identifying variety in store (Traceability checklist)	In place
Access control	Unauthorised access, visitor contamination risk	Farm generally not open to the public; visitor log book to be introduced (see outstanding action)	Linked to visitor log book action

3. Soil Management Plan

This sits alongside the farm's Nutrient Management Plan (which covers nutrient applications) and addresses soil structure, organic matter and erosion risk.

- Soil testing: carried out within the last 5 years across the farm (see Certificates — soil analysis reports on file).
- Soil organic matter: reviewed annually as part of the SFI1 SAM1 action — [CONFIRM latest test date/result with Savills or agronomist if not already in the Hub].
- Cultivation approach: [CONFIRM current practice — min-till / plough / direct drill — and how this varies by soil type/field].
- Erosion and run-off risk: no watercourses on the farm (confirmed 24 Sep 2026), so run-off to water is not a live risk on this holding; residual risk is soil loss/structure damage on sloping ground — [CONFIRM which fields, if any, are steep enough to need cover-cropping or contour cultivation].
- Organic matter maintenance: FYM/organic manure applications recorded (see Fertiliser checklist); cover cropping under SFI3 SOH3 across ~57ha (Silo Field, Steins Park, Fawley Bottom, 20 Acres, Hangings Hill and one further parcel) also supports soil structure.
- Compaction management: [CONFIRM routine — e.g. avoiding travel on wet ground, tyre pressure management, subsoiling where needed].

Once the [CONFIRM] items above are filled in with James's input, this becomes the working Soil Management Plan referenced on the day.